



As far as connectivity is concerned, that should not be an issue in daily use. The earbuds come with the latest Bluetooth 5.3 and do not have connection drops across three walls, as I found out when walking around the office with them on.

PERFORMANCE

When it comes to the sound signature of the Redmi Buds 4 Active, it is very similar to what we have come to expect and find in earbuds priced between the ₹1,000 to ₹2,000 mark.

As you can see in both graphs, there's a very apparent boost in the bass frequencies. This is very normal for earbuds that are catered to the Indian masses as the taste is generally geared towards having a bass-forward sound signature. Given the boost, many would expect that it would get muddy and eat into other frequencies. But during my time with the earbuds, I did not feel that it impacted the mids and the highs that much.

The mids come pretty close to our baseline reading of the pink noise, and the boost in the highs makes sure that in tracks across genres, you get as balanced of a sound as you can when you are spending just over ₹1,000 on a pair of TWS earbuds. After the testing ended, I moved away from our regular song suite and listened to some quintessentially Indian songs. And, in those tracks, the performance of these earbuds shined through.

I honestly did not expect these headphones to give me the experience

that they did. In songs like Obsession which has been doing rounds on Instagram, the vocals, the bass response, and most instruments were clear, and the song felt well-rounded.

Coming to the ENC, as prefaced earlier, it also was a pleasant surprise for me. I used the tips that came in out of the box (medium) as they gave me the optimal seal. And once that was set, the ENC made sure that around the 55 per cent volume mark, most of the ambient sounds, like that of an AC, were drowned out almost completely. The sound of the clicking of my mechanical keyboard was also very muted.

All in all, if you are someone who has a taste for hip-hop, Bollywood, and similar genres of music, then you will thoroughly enjoy what these earbuds have on offer. The ENC is the cherry on top!

The low latency mode drained the battery on these earbuds, but during gaming and watching videos, a trained person would notice the improvement in performance that it brings. So, if you are willing to compromise a bit on the overall battery life of these earbuds, then you can essentially keep it on all the time.

Talking about the battery life, let's move on to the penultimate section of the review before I get to the verdict.

BATTERY

Xiaomi claims that these earbuds last about 5 hours on a single charge, with the case providing about six more rounds of charging, bringing the total

battery life on the buds to 30 hours. In my time with the earbuds, testing them, I got 4 hours and 15 minutes of battery life, which is pretty close to the numbers claimed by the brand.

When you are out of charge, you can use a USB-C cable to juice these earbuds. These earbuds sport fast charging which means that they can provide about 90 minutes of playback on 10 minutes of charge. This again is a nice inclusion.

VERDICT

My final word on the Redmi Buds 4 Active would be that you can go for it if you are looking for a pair of earbuds below ₹1,500. They are a well-rounded pair of earbuds. But you need to test out the controls if they work for you or not. In my experience, the controls could have been much more refined than what they are right now.

If that works out for you, I doubt that only a few other offerings would be able to match up to the looks, feel, and performance of these earbuds. At the time of launch, these are retailing for ₹1,199. Most other alternatives are either wired or neckband, with only a few TWS, like ones by Truke, coming close to them.

—Satvik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Drivers: 2mm Bass Pro Drivers | Battery Life: Up to 30 Hours | Google Fast Pair: Yes | IP Rating: IPX4 | Environmental Noise Cancellation | Low Latency Mode: Up to 60 ms

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